



Life demand Death

free version



autofictional novel
in vignettes

Gorm Braarvig
gorm@aigap.no

free version





<https://aigap.no/mlist>

Zero Sum

*"Riding my motorcycle from Kiel to Alicante averaging 170 km/h,
I could have been arrested all over Europe", I said.
The lawyer I had just met over a Whisky chuckled.
"No, you should be dead"*

*Maybe so, but I feel nothing anyway, except shame
towards my loved ones. Perhaps through Music,
I can experience the loss of sanity as sound,
time standing still, breakdown and realization.*

Death makes room

Zero-Summary

A death makes room for a life

<https://aigap.no/mncty>



Does new life demand that something old dies to make space? Are resources and therefore opportunities limited?

Zero-Summary is about resource allocation without the ability to create resources from nothing; you must choose between keeping old things alive and creating something new. There isn't room to do both at once.

A result measure of innovation that few understand is how much you manage to stop doing to make room for something new. Some call the effect of having too much "legacy cost", and the system is often referred to as "the Zero-Sum Game". An alternative to the model is to assume that you can create value through progress and not just distribute value based on yesterday's premises. Positive-sum games are described in a later chapter. For this death also entails that the zero-sum model must die, but it must be felt first.

An effect template for innovation is progress. I don't think we call it innovation if it doesn't entail a new perceived improvement; then you can discuss whether it's enough that only the experience is new. For me, it has been true: one describes the application of artificial intelligence as innovative even though the ideas may be 50 years old, and the world just wasn't ready yet. From this perspective, I write about perceived improvement; for the other kind, the objective improvement, I can't just guess. I know my own truths and can speak about them with full integrity.

I will therefore start with some stories that are true for me, unbalanced and perhaps even objectively imprecise. The space that was created in my life is about a subjectively true experience of realities. I know I can honestly and precisely share my experiences, fragmented and at times desperate.

If I, for example, say that the motorcycle helmet cracked, not like in the movies, but in a senseless crash that once again embedded itself as lasting physical fear in my body, it might be that the episode was more or less dramatic for those who saw me go down. My feeling is nonetheless true and neither underreported nor dramatized. Several times, people have thought they witnessed a fatal accident, while for me it was a, relatively speaking, minor mishap not described in this book.

Lotte

O Fortuna, Carl Orff

<https://aigap.no/mcb>



*I don't want to meet a woman; a woman notice it.
She stood next to me at classical concert in the Palace Park.*

*We didn't speak for a long time; she moved like me, adapted to how I
stood and moved, impossible not to notice. After a few minutes she said
"Depeche Mode". I didn't understand anything. "Personal Jesus?" I
said. She nodded in confirmation. "You don't need to understand", she
said, "just go with it".*

*Neither of us said anything until the next piece finished; she stood like
me and moved like me, but with small differences that made it
non-invasive. "O Fortuna" from Carmina Burana played while the rain
lashed; she was as unchangeable as I was, but we decided simultaneously
to leave.*

I know communication tricks; she knew more. Or maybe this woman was naturally sensual and wanted to get to know me. Like other men, I can no longer tell the difference. The game from Tinder took over how we meet. "Natural" has passed away and was buried in 2015. Or so I thought.

"You think you know what natural is, but have you also forgotten how it feels?" Lotte suddenly said. In a chaos of fantastic music and rain, I couldn't understand if she was talking about me, herself, or describing the personality between us. Maybe something happened I didn't understand. We left the rain, walked down Karl Johans gate and into Brødrene Bergh where a DJ played Soul.

Lotte and I mirrored each other, bodily, then verbally, and were thrown out of Brødrene Bergh at closing. Time gone.

"You think you're confused now? Wait until you realize what happens if we stop thinking", I imagined she said to me. But she was gone. "I have the self-confidence to stand with the beautiful one, but self-esteem made me ashamed of it". She mirrored me; did she have her own shame or was she mirroring mine? "Self-confidence and self-loathing", I said aloud to myself.

Doesn't matter. We enjoyed each other with all senses.

Hypersensitive and mirroring or calculating by the book, she can keep her mysticism. Later I learn she has faith I lack, and that the space we give each other makes disagreement enriching without friction. So we will grow tired of each other in the future.

Doesn't matter. I have no future.

Broken things are beautiful to the devout. She is a woman of God. The kind who sees the beauty in what is broken.

Shame, goodness, and evil. Theoretically processed. She has done all kinds of reflection. Now it's time for sensation. Secure in presence, accustomed to life as death.

I scratched the surface, enough reflection. She deserves real. Not slowly. Enjoy without reflection. Instincts can decide without afterthought. People of belief also have the human right to desire and be desired. The exception was Lotte's dualism, which I reflected on; the divide between spirit and physical reality once kept the mysticism of faiths alive. With me, Lotte's dualism gives too little; I pretend I am too simple for us to have intellectual overlap.

That is my dualism, constructed for shared happiness in misfortune.

Hard to get hold of. Don't contact; she deserves a "mission" to proselytize, or to say "Mission accepted". After three days, a message came from her; she had found my name. I reply after five. Too good to preserve. Won't last.

We met a second time after a week. Lotte was animalistic in bed for a week. I didn't want to end up in bed with her; just having her in the crook of my arm was enough. "You think this is about sex?" said Lotte, so I kissed her on the mouth. "It's about letting life happen", she said. We went home to her and didn't go out again for days.

After that, I haven't seen her.

I didn't meet her.



The old is no more

Ohne Dich, Rammstein

<https://aigap.no/mod>



The sound of glass plate shattering into a thousand pieces is the sound you hear when a motorcycle helmet is destroyed on the ground. If you're wearing the helmet.

The world I knew had gone to hell. I remember the moment I realized it, just before I went into a coma. The world didn't go to hell in an instant, but the realization came like a bang I've only experienced when I smash a motorcycle helmet headfirst into the asphalt. I remember three of the four times I've smashed my helmet, all have left lasting mark on me. I don't know why realization that world is not the same could hit harder than life-threatening accidents, but it did.

“Ohne Dich” - An hour into a conversation with “J”, a far too young, and for her own happiness, brilliant, Ukrainian

romantic interest, we shared musical favorites. My chosen song, a song by Rammstein, is about the loss of a mother. For me, the song is not only about the loss of my own mother, but is also an emotional anchor for many things that are forever lost. Without you, I cannot exist in the same way.

The young woman I spoke to daily lived in a borrowed holiday cabin in Bordeaux, where she also cared for her mother. The apartments the family owned in Kiev no longer had any full windows, they had all been shattered as a result of the city being bombed. The bright girl needed full windows around her in her international middle management job.

"Und die Vögel singen nicht mehr". When I first met her I found out she was smarter than me. A bottomless woman who noticed that I registered that she was a multidimensional being. Not oversensitive like Scandinavian gifted ladies, although they too are doomed to a life of more ability than happiness. This woman from war-torn Ukraine was also doomed to a life of cruelty baptized by evil and pain. The underlying nerdy vulnerability is the same in all those women who received books as reward when they were good girls, but those gifted from war and misery lose life's illusions in bottomless pain. The bird sings no more.

"Mit dir bin ich auch allein". There was nothing I could say that changed the fact that the ground beneath her feet was gone. Her home, her mother's and sister's home, and the remains of a gifted family who came from Tsjornobyl were destroyed. I haven't dug into all the hidden stories that must lie there, but they could probably fill a bookshelf full of books. I kept it a secret from J that, driven by anger, I was determined to travel and take up arms in Ukraine, even as a 20 years too old ex Recon soldier, I saw the Russians as the aggressors of all of Europe at that time. But there was something else that almost killed me. J and I enjoyed each other's attention, but were already alone in shared moments.

"Mit dir stehen die Sekunden". After inviting J to ride my motorcycle when she stopped by Oslo on a work trip, I found out I could do better. After intuitively sensing the fear she was trying to hide, I gave her another break from life. Attention and a conversation with a man who enjoyed her company with bubbles and mussels to the sea breeze under the sun. The second hand stopped with her.

"Doch der Abend wirft ein Tuch aufs Land". Afterwards we went to the place for bubbles, attention and more break from the hard life. When she stretched her body and the time really came to kiss her, I laughed in a way that could only be understood as offensive. Self-destruction took over from

passion and just an hour later I kissed her goodbye on the forehead like a sibling. The adventure was over and the night on dark roads awaited. The evening cloth over the world had already been thrown.

In a normal world, I would have married such a woman, but my world was already on fire.

"Ohne dich zähl ich die Stunden". I gave up on the world. It was the COVID epidemic when I started regularly life-threatening driving at night with a heavy motorcycle. Mostly with alcohol in my blood. After I was acting as co-judge in a pedophile case, the pain inside me became so intense that normal fear and pain thresholds disappeared. The beauty of the night, survival of mortal danger, the brutality and the encounter with the wild animals of the night drowned out the reasonable horror. In no way did I want to exterminate myself, on the other hand I appreciated life more for each surprising survival. The house keys were lost on a beach in the south, I didn't want to go home, I didn't know that the countdown in hours had begun.

"Mit dir steh'n die Sekunden". In moments of mortal danger, when seconds stand still, one can be alone, but not lonely. The fourth time I smashed a helmet on the asphalt, I felt neither pain nor noise. At first I was hyperfocused on

how to stop, because I was skidding at a sufficiently high speed, head first into the roadway. After stopping I called my daughters and their mother to tell them I had flipped my bike. Finally, I took a break while a veterinarian saved my life. She used her blouse to slow the bleeding enough for the ambulance to get me to the emergency room in time. I know this because she got the money back for her blouse on my insurance. Consciousness disappeared; with you, seconds stand still.

But I have skipped some stories.



Funny at the gas station

Harder Than You Think, Public Enemy

<https://aigap.no/mhtyt>



It's raining a little; I stop to fill up with gas. There's a woman behind the counter smiling. I smile back. "Can you turn off this rain?" "Yes, I'll just turn it off here," she says kindly.

"I can't turn it off, but I know when it's going to start raining; it gets humid in here before it rains," she continues warmly.

I play along. "That's interesting; the humidity starts inside and then becomes rain; how strange," I reply with engagement. "But stopping it, that's not possible."

"I hear that all the others who have those cooling systems on the roof have it like that; the humidity comes inside first."

"Is it because the low-pressure system pushes humid air in, and

the cooling system cools it down, so the indoor climate becomes damp, heavy, and humid? Can air under high pressure hold less moisture?"

"Now look at the door," she points to the refrigerator door covered in condensation.

We agree that it's going to rain today.

My ideal when I was 16 was to work at a gas station for the rest of my life; it has never happened that I've worked at one.

A small, manageable ecosystem where people come in from the outside. Complex enough to provide variety, and simple enough to provide stability.

Seems like a good life to me.

But if you're too curious, you get thrown onto other paths. Coming back is not the same. You also get hated, like in Plato's cave. "You think too much," they say for the rest of your life.

Maybe I have worked at a gas station after all. Places you're not aware of having the mentality of.

I probably succeeded in finding the little life many times anyway.

MC to the Mediterranean and a flame Wanted *Dead or Alive*, Bon Jovi

<https://aigap.no/mwdoa>



Heavy motorcycle. It's December 2022 and bike season is over. Whether it was safe to ride or not, was judged based on whether forecast had shown sub-zero temperatures during the night; now it wasn't safe anymore. If you ride on ice with a heavy motorcycle, the front wheel slips and you immediately hit the ground with no chance to influence it. That's how I destroyed my first Ducati and my first helmet.

I found a map of Europe and looked at where I could stay from December to March where it was above freezing; Italy was high on the list.

"It's all the same, only the names will change". I looked at the map; the Mediterranean looked good, Italy, Spain, maybe Morocco or Turkey. The country was unimportant; what mattered was the escape

from a Norway of isolation, freezing temperatures, and stagnation. The drive was unshakable. Everything is the same: cities, people, and values. There are many different names for the freedom I sought.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted text block 3]

[Redacted text block 4]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

"I'm wanted dead or alive". With an average speed of 170 km/h, I lived in a constant borderland between prison, madness, or my own fatal accident. I am still ashamed of it because of my children, but adrenaline and endorphins boiled: willing to pay the highest price for my new freedom, I had fled a slow, silent, greyish death in a bureaucracy overcrowded with case officers at a strategic level. It was like I learned in the military's reconnaissance service: my duty as a prisoner was to escape. I felt wanted, dead or alive.

[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted text block 3]

[Redacted text block 4]

[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted text block 3]



[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted text block 3]

[Redacted text block 4]



[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]



[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted text block 3]

[Redacted text block 4]



for her and a note in the margin for myself; everyone around me had become spectators to my death ritual on the road. The time without top speed grew shorter for each day. I was alive, and was going to be happy by the Mediterranean for weeks.

But my sanity had let go.



Miswired

Remember Me, Blue Boy

<https://aigap.no/mrm>



After grandfather's time, those who live off communication or change have learned that nudging, in English "priming," also works and shapes us. Manipulatively helping, loving, or selling.

The order matters, because what comes first is later weighted against everything else.

"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be a woman."

"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be in a woman."

"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be in a woman."

"Men get imprisoned for that. Nice to be a woman."

If we begin with humor and surprise afterwards, it's crude flirting. In reverse order, it becomes an overstep followed by confusion exposed as manipulative.

Interpretation is the reader's privilege, for what I know, you might prefer the last one.

The early flame

State of Emergency, Cactus World News

<https://aigap.no/msoe>



I had reached the woman I should have married 25 years earlier. Now she lived in the beautiful mountain landscape just inland from Alicante in Southern Spain. If only I hadn't been self-destructive, we would have been married and happy. C didn't know that I loved her, because once, 30 years ago, in a way so she would hear it, I said that I had only loved three women in my entire life, and she was not on the list. The list consisted of Ina, Pamela, and Karoline. It was probably because she wasn't on the list of women I had loved that she, in between, over the years, had unconsciously tried to get on the list and never gave up on me. Women like challenges; I was the one who slipped away.

The lie back then was just as useful now, a generation later, to ensure I still wouldn't end up happy with C.

I adjusted nothing. Visits to beautiful areas around Alicante and walks with her dog were occasionally interrupted by work on national strategies for a directorate. Maybe I should calm down and survive after all; maybe my soul could heal enough so that fear and reason secured my survival with a gradually improved life all the way to retirement age.

The dilemma of not wishing yourself well and then ending up hurting others to hurt yourself was never clearer than with C. When you end up depending on each other for happiness, it can go both ways.

She needed to feel wanted. Got everything else, but not that. Impossible for those who have never experienced both sides; scars from childhood. If you have never felt loved, you can't make others feel good.

In the life that was, the person I was still lingers. I can never.



Earlier summer parties

Memories, David Guetta feat Kid Cudi

<https://aigap.no/mmern>



We sat for six hours talking at a hip Grünerløkka place and couldn't finish a bottle of champagne; we had far too much to talk about. But it ended with that evening; we never met again.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

The night was still young and things escalated; [Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
that choice I would really overdo
later.

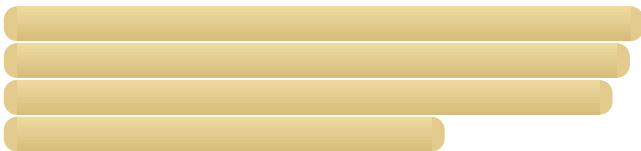
Child abuse and wounds

Hurt, Johnny Cash

<https://aigap.no/mhnin>



There is no consequence to leaning too far out of the window. Until you fall. Then you are not prepared.



*You
don't know where the line goes, but I was in free fall; now I just had to
hit the ground.*

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

The accused was acquitted. [REDACTED]

Abuse and wounds (Alternative)

Knockin' on Heaven's Door, Dylan

<https://aigap.no/mkohd>



Evening. I drove with the devil at my heels. Didn't reflect on the dust on the road to Oslo municipality. Just before I spun out of control and flew over the handlebars, I reflected on the day.



[Redacted]

[Redacted]

Silence.

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]



[Redacted text bar]

[Redacted text block containing 7 lines]

[Redacted text block containing 6 lines]

I think of the window I am falling out of.

[Redacted text block containing 3 lines]

[Redacted text bar]

[Redacted text block containing 2 lines]



Only later do I understand what she means. The fall was the beginning.
Not the end.



Women and death

O mio babbino caro, Puccini & Forzano

<https://aigap.no/mombc>



This book is about women and death. What do women have to do with death? Both have to do with life. At any given time, a woman is the most important thing in a man's life, and life cannot exist without death. Even though the woman can represent the opposite of death, both give meaning or make room for life.



200 km/h, and beyond

Battle Without Honor or Humanity

<https://aigap.no/mbwhoh>



When riding motorcycle at top speed through night, you are visible and audible. It is a secret that the rider has a state of absolute, liberating silence.

Your body enters a state of hyperfocus driven by fear of annihilation. Senses dull, impressions leave after minutes of madness.

Deafening, monotonous roar of wind against your helmet fades first. Next, any conscious reflection on movements, curves, scenery, wildlife, traffic, and lights disappears. Your existence dissolves into routine motions and actions, patterns and vibrations. Details slip away from every sense.

Finally bodily pain and tension vanish. There is no room for strain. Energy is conserved, and breathing shifts downward towards calm, deep rhythm from the belly. Shoulders drop, pain and your brains exhaustion gets filtered out. You enter a hypnotic state that surpasses sitting in lotus position or using drugs.

All psychological troubles become irrelevant, pain too. Ultimate silence lies at heart of a deafening roar, sound audible from afar, unheard when you are sitting where the noise originates. You do not need Freud nor Jung; you are healed. Or die.

Zero-sum life dies; creation without destruction becomes possible. Death makes way for new life.





<https://aigap.no/mklz>



Crisis!

Speed, noise and risk killed old self,
once a bullet, suddenly broken on asphalt.

Delirium made world dissolve into dream of
judgment and shallow desire.

To survive, I had to let the old die.

The Accident

Time to die, The Stranglers

<https://aigap.no/mttd>



The part of me that died from the life-saving treatment in the ER gave the opportunity for the end of a life, an identity, a self. How much I would keep of what I had been, I could choose myself. The advantage of coma and delirium is that so little remains of who you were that you can rewrite yourself.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

I flew over the handlebars of the motorcycle at speed, slow enough for survival, fast enough for major injuries. The first thing to hit the ground breaks; for me, it was the right leg.

[Redacted text block]



[Redacted text line]

[Redacted text block consisting of six lines]

The spine had compression fractures in the 2nd, 3rd, and 6th vertebrae from the top, but I was not paralyzed.

[Redacted text block consisting of five lines]

[Redacted text block consisting of seven lines]





[Redacted text block]

Morphine of all types was implanted in the body, placed in the back, given intravenously, and served in pill form. Fast-acting and long-acting.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]





[Redacted text block]

After the episode, I have never again asked anyone to pull themselves together if they are scared; I am now aware that it is not a given that it is possible.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

The advantage of going crazy is, as is also said about death and stupidity, that it is not your own problem, only a problem for those closest to you. The disadvantage of going crazy is that it is a problem for those around you.

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

The life as it was is no more. But it doesn't have to be worse; now there is room to build something new.

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

It was completely out of the question for my family to visit. They had to survive.



20 km/h, and bellow

Flower, Moby

<https://aigap.no/mfm>



Along the sea, there are smooth rocks, and suddenly I find myself running, in the same way in the twilight in the forest, running into the night on the smooth rocks.

Just like running at under 20 km/h, the senses let go, and even though a fall doesn't automatically mean death, not even major injuries, the effect resembles the one I have with a motorcycle at over 200 km/h.

Calculating being Sweet Dreams, Eurythmics

<https://aigap.no/msdamot>



[Redacted text block containing multiple lines of obscured text]

When asked if she liked motorcycles, she replied, "I hear about that all my working day";

[Redacted text block containing multiple lines of obscured text]



A charming man from the Mediterranean who has probably been pulling women for some decades. Now he is in his late 60s, so I assumed the pace was slowing down, but there I was wrong.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

I got angry and said: "On behalf of us older than the pyramids, we don't want it like that".

Dishes

Road to Nowhere, Talking Heads

<https://aigap.no/mrtn>



There was more tableware in the cupboard, but the sink for washing dishes was full. The last time this happened, I had thrown the dishes in the trash, but now I was short on money. Glanced at the paper plates. Looked at the pizza in the freezer. Both solutions I had used too much. Had to do the dishes. Couldn't just sit on the motorcycle. Couldn't just geek out on AI solutions. First hygiene, tidying up, dishes. I was going to starve to death. It smelled less of the dishes now. I had gotten used to it and wondered how far from normal I had become.

Time to wash the dishes. I drove to Tvedestrand and had a beer. Fast enough to forget the dishes.

You don't need a psychologist if you have an MC, but is it really so good to numb all natural signals and find an easy way out for everything?

It was a regular dream. I was still staring at the dishes.

The woman came out of the bedroom and stood between me and the sink.

Ugh. "Tove, will you go out and buy a coffee while I wash the dishes?"

Ugh. Had forgotten she was here. Damn dishes.

Tove said something I didn't catch; her voice was melodic and combined with her warm gaze, it was more than enough to sense. "I like your voice and I'm not listening," I said. "You know the lyrics to every song you've heard; I don't even know the lyrics to my favorite music," I said. "Is it because the small details are so exciting to me, and because you have a photographic memory?" Tove's forehead turned a little redder, reminding me of yesterday's argument.

I became happier and happier, appreciating the little quirks Tove has when she argues; her forehead grew redder and redder, and there was that annoying twitch by her eye she had talked about but I had never gotten to see.

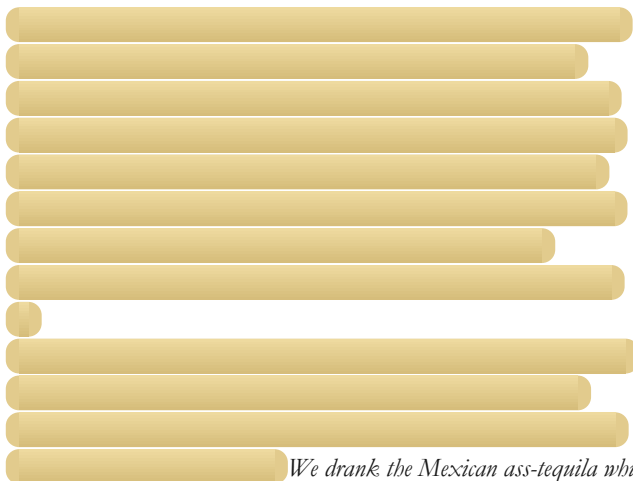
"I'm married," she said. I thought she was mine; doesn't matter. The door slammed shut; she was gone. It took two minutes before I ran out into the hallway and looked for her; I haven't seen her since.

Time to hit the road again. Brønnøysund the day after tomorrow; might as well leave now. The dishes were still there two weeks later when I came home to Oslo.

The beauty that lasted a moment

You look like rain, Morphine

<https://aigap.no/myllr>



*We drank the Mexican ass-tequila while
I flambéed the entrecote, and then I avoided her for the rest of the party.
She was visibly ambivert*



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

"Cause you look like rain". Neither of us knew that the countdown was over. The romance the following week was replaced by the emergency room, and the bed closest to the basement exit at Ullevål; then came the coma and the fight for survival and sanity. You look like rain.



[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Life as I knew it was over. Death made room for a completely new life; the relationship with U was not meant to last, but to give hope. We achieved that.

Karin is inspiration

Into My Arms, Nick Cave

<https://aigap.no/mima>



A muse that gives Desire. Lust. Life! The goddess of artistic form from Greek mythology; a source of inspiration in our modern world. The writing took off again. I bathe in the icy water every sunrise to grow back the manhood she speaks of. The man from the previous millennium resurrected.

On the back of the MC, she likes speed better than curves.

"Reality is better than truth", I shout to myself and feel like I'm in a Greek play at the Steiner School.

She gives and receives everything, without anyone erasing themselves. We disagree and agree without adjusting the slightest for the other. Perfection in the real, raw, unformed. She is nothing like me, and that is delicious.

"Thank you for speaking to me as a man", I say; it's not very manly, I am man enough to ignore it. "I have found another, and that is you". We shall inspire each other rather than shape each other. She doesn't know she taught me that.

Karin liked MCs so much that she bought her own Triumph. It became MC, and not a holiday, this year. After spending all the money on exclusive holidays for many years, it was over, both for her and her children; now it was self-realization and motorcycles. I don't know if you can call it a midlife crisis, because this just seemed very pleasurable, as far as I could judge. It became a Triumph and driving lessons.

She sat on the back with me on her own new bike. We rode south along the coast for a couple of hours and rested at a gem by the sea. After a short break, we rode back, and she became quiet. Suddenly she didn't reply anymore. I was an extra in her adventure, which was freedom on her own motorcycle. Recognizable.

After a month, we were supposed to have another trip where she rode her own bike and I mine. Still as training. Suddenly she cancelled. It was over.

They say everyone is the main character in their own life; maybe her life no longer had room for as much personality as I carried with me. I don't know and didn't ask.

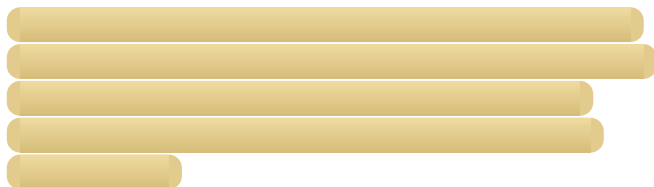
She read the Book of Revelation, the journey through the death of the old towards new life. The theme this book is about. What was a resurrection in my life was part of the death in hers. The transition from the old to the new. The new in her belongs to a time after mine. Perhaps after another death, for I still love her.



Eyeing at "Bensern"

Material Girl, Madonna

<https://aigap.no/mmg>



"What a man, gets little", I thought.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block] *Two steps back. "That's it. I'm not going to hurt the priest I'm with".*

[Redacted]

[Redacted] *I wasn't*
ready. Now it was time to ride the MC. [Redacted]

[Redacted]



40 km/h & salt taste on morning

Free Fallin, Tom Petty

<https://aigap.no/mff>



I have a salty taste in my mouth. Noticed the taste on the way into the day with the engine idling. The rising sunrise woke me. The World Cup quarter-final was over a couple of hours ago, and the night has not yet turned to day. My brother's family, whom I watched the match with, will sleep for many hours. Not me. I sneak out and notice my niece waving at me. She is having a peaceful morning moment at night. We nod briefly to each other while I look forward to my own moment in silence. Sunrise on quiet roads with a big lazy motorcycle without meeting people. Every reason to smile. Niece gets hers, I get mine.

The motorcycle behaved strangely; stops at the 24-hour gas station and refills air in the rear tire. Over 300kg motorcycle tips over on the ground; I continue filling air. The rear wheel sticks up in the air, so it's easier. A passerby stares from a safe distance.

The day before, I had forgotten to put on my helmet, rode without a helmet between the Opera and the entrance to the highway. Midday, in the middle of Oslo city center. Today it was about tipping a heavy MC on the ground while filling air in the rear tire without stopping filling air. Something in me was in crisis.

That the bike had tipped over without me reacting, and everything just seemed natural, was surely a bad sign. Ah well, reflection doesn't fit at night. After lifting the joy machine back onto two wheels, squinting for a second at gasoline or oil that had run out, and feeling the left arm aching from lifting the heavy MC, I started the engine. The arm would ache for a couple of days. The engine would start. Still alive, still moving. I rode into the sunrise towards the sea.

Full tank took only seven liters extra gasoline after 116 kilometers of riding. Low fuel consumption and brain idling. With clear signs of gradual deterioration, it was time for a trip without destination. The bag strapped with a belt on the back of the motorcycle was packed with book, Mac, stove, water, and coffee powder. If the Mac wasn't finally destroyed because the MC tipped over, I would write an article. If the Mac was destroyed, I had a book to enjoy, signed to a chaplain who worked in prisons. Prison priest.

My nervous system calmed completely. On the road at 40 km/h alone towards the sea. Peace.

Unexpected salt taste hit my senses before I reached the sea. Brilliant sun and salt taste in my mouth. My brain searched for reasons for sorrow, and only registered that, yes, there were rivers under both eyes, and paths led into my mouth. Salt taste.

Lost love for the prison priest had crept into my subconscious and made me traffic-hazardous. I stopped at a small café. "You won't get over her anytime soon, especially not sexually", I said aloud to tears flowing while church bells sounded nearby. Appropriate. What a pathetic bastard existed in me. But one who enjoyed strength in feeling alive. Physically and emotionally. Still capable of feeling real and experienced pain. Sign of capacity for love. Nothing dead; my heart pumped truly and honestly.

"Contact with feelings occurs in the pauses between active thoughts", I made myself say to myself. "New Age Coaching", the kind of self-talk with ambiguously interpretable hypnotic language, is something I truly despise people passionately seeking. Self-loathing overshadowed the sorrow only for a moment.

It hurts. Pain is a sign of life, a reality that should truly not be reacted to. Now I am broken by a priest, one robust enough to handle me.

I have time. It will take time to move on. Closer.

Prison with open door

Crockett's Theme, Jan Hammer

<https://aigap.no/mct>



Mortal danger on a motorcycle as an antidote to inner pain is melancholic. If you don't want to die. I don't. Didn't. Don't know; intention has given way to habits; habits have expired.

200 years ago, a Dane wrote: "When the Danger is so great that Death has become Hope, then Despair is this: not to be able to die" (The Sickness unto Death, Kierkegaard, 1849).



Wondering if the Danish philosopher post-rationalized pain or after-effects of pain. He strikes me as brave, one who feels pain in the moment it should hurt, but not before and not after. Hindsight is also wisdom, of course, and this one has lasted 200 years.



The female doctor

Born to Run, Bruce Springsteen

<https://aigap.no/mbtr>



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

I ask a woman how cool it isn't that she rides a "widowmaker" (a type of motorcycle); she looks sadly at me and



says: "so terrible"; she is a professor and subject matter expert in something related to women's rights in health and is genuinely good; I feel my own ambivalent so-called goodness and feel that I have failed as a human in some areas she has excelled in throughout her life.

[Redacted text block containing 15 lines of yellowed-out text]

[Redacted text block containing 5 lines of yellowed-out text]



[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED] *I can't dance and had quite freshly broken ribs and a collarbone from a small MC mishap.*

[REDACTED]

Counter-current bill

Would I lie To You, Duophonic

<https://aigap.no/mwilty>



My freedom. "V". Rock hard in her own big life change. I didn't want to gorge on the truth with things from my life that weren't going to affect her directly. Not gorge on the truth. The choice affected her directly.

If one omits telling the truth: Is that the same as a lie? I don't think so; it depends on the intention. My intention was not to worry the woman I was dating, or was it perhaps shame?

We sat at Lorry's in Bogstadveien. She had had a bad evening and was tipsy. She had met "meksen" at a bar, not a good man. She had deliberately moved to my part of town in hopes of sleeping at my place.



[Redacted text block 1]

[Redacted text block 2]

[Redacted text block 3]

[Redacted text block 4]

[Redacted text block 5]



She lives in a boat next to "Bensern"

Orinoco Flow, Enya

<https://aigap.no/mof>



M lives in a boat. Right by "Bensern". She used to run a café and now lives year-round on the boat. "The bar was called Håpløs", she says. "Not that it went bankrupt". I let it go. Everyone has the right to post-rationalize.

The woman barked but not unkindly. The little terrier wagged and barked. She had more knowledge about dogs than me, so much so that she put a price on the way I treated it. Let the dog come to me. I indicated leadership without need for display, which made the dog secure. All the other things I can do without "threat" or dried meat. I insisted that I feel I am good with dogs, but anyone with dried beef wins.

M reveals that the price of living in a boat there has doubled in ten years, and that electricity is no longer included. "Cash cow", I mutter, and she looks at me questioningly.

R sits outside M outside "Bensern"

The Passenger, Iggy Pop

<https://aigap.no/mtp>



"But I've
had accidents; it's far too dangerous". "That's just cowardly", I say.
"He's just stolen an identity that has nothing to do with qualities or
personality", I think.

K from Haugesund & C looks down on him

T.N.T. AC/DC

<https://aigap.no/mtnt>



His face is full of scars from fighting, and when he was 17, he ate a glass to show off to the 20-year-olds and was accepted. These guys do well in the选拔 for the Navy SEALs, and one or two percent get accepted. He belongs to the other 98-99 percent. Those who didn't become Navy SEALs, but are just as aggressive. Just not as tough or stable. Or too high or low intelligence. Or without color vision or enough eyesight to have a clean record.

"My girlfriend broke up with me; we lived together", says J. "Where does she live?" No, we both had to move. Now I live with friends". He's looking for new ways to try his hand at life. Preferably fighting a bit, like they do where he grew up. Back to childhood, so to speak. Yellow belt in Brazilian Jiu Jitsu he's gotten, and he picks fights with those who are 20 cm taller than him.

We get to know K and have a beer. Nice, but it's always uncertain whether we'll end up in a conflict situation; he has so much pent-up anger that there's a tense atmosphere in the air.



Someone from the waterworks, or a dirty guy

Common People, Pulp

<https://aigap.no/mcp>



It was a warm summer day and it was not recommended to swim in the innermost part of the Oslofjord. I was going to swim anyway and saw a lone guy at the otherwise so popular Sørenga. "How's the water?" I asked. "Quite okay, it's a decent temperature for the season" "You know it's not recommended to swim; too many bacteria in the water, or else a sewage plant is leaking. I don't know, but it doesn't smell. Maybe they've put chlorine in it".

He looked at me with a gaze as if he were an experienced guide, one of the few who knows a difficult path and he can be best at direction. "Yes. The bacteria level. Due to the temperature over time. I work for the waterworks. I know everything about this". "But you're in swimming trunks; you're not going to swim now with that job?" I wondered. He was. "It's not good to drink liters of this water; we have to be strict, because children get a lot of water in their mouths and swallow water. I'm not a child, and I don't drink saltwater".



<https://aigap.no/mltf>

Rebuild

Woke up blank, old self gone.

Body learning to live again.

Can I love without breaking?

Future is a door to open.

Still breathing, still trying.



When you open your eyes, you're back

Good Thing, Fine Young Cannibals

<https://aigap.no/mgt>



about "the problem of evil"; how evil can exist in an existence where God is good. I don't remember how I got onto it, but I said, "I have myself been psychotic, fell into delirium after operations four years ago." "That's not psychosis," said the experienced spiritual counselor.

She was there; I denied madness, chose life.

Blank pages

Little Wing, Jimi Hendrix

<https://aigap.no/mlw>



When I woke up, I had room. Room to breathe, room to see. The coma had cleared away part of the old life, the heavy, self-destructive past, and made room for a completely new life with completely new possibilities. Sanity died; I had, in a way, annihilated myself, but a void was created to build a completely new life.

I was her first patient at the elitist Rikshospitalet, and she told me about the trips she wanted to take in the mountains. I told her about mine I had planned in the Pyrenees with J. I convinced her to go to a Rammstein concert. She remembered me and our relationship well two years later when I came for a check-up; we had shared many conversations while I was in Delirium and using morphine.

Three years after discharge, I tracked her down and sent a message. The adventure was no longer her reality. That's okay.

Strength from neglect

The Logical Song, Supertramp

<https://aigap.no/mtls>



Three years after the accident, I sit in a student café.

Blank yellow bars for writing the first paragraph of the story.

Blank yellow bars for writing the second paragraph of the story.

*Once I had entered the café, I saw a woman occupying the four best seats.
When asked if one was free,*



she shook her head. The smell of genderless nihilism from people who have never experienced real resistance or an unpaid bill, the Norwegian coldness. Clinical, intellectual, and cynical.





[Redacted text block containing 10 lines of text]

Watch what you say, or they'll call you radical.

[Redacted text block containing 7 lines of text]

[Redacted text block containing 7 lines of text]



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

The man clearing his throat for air mirrors my own earlier escape at 200 km/h to drown out my inner anxiety. Before, the machine was the only cry for help, but I am reborn.

[Redacted text block]

As best we could

Strange Little Girl, The Strangers

<https://aigap.no/mslg>



But the provocation and the start were real!

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

I had to go home early. I could neither endure nor delve into

the darkness in the woman. I said it, H, but I didn't have the surplus to be there for you.



Even though the soul was reborn, it would take time to get the body back in shape.

Micro-relationships

GOTH, Sidewalks and Skeletons

<https://aigap.no/mgsr>



We were at a party and met for the first time. I asked if she was the physiotherapist, but I had confused her with another woman at the same party; great start for a woman used to far too much attention. We decided to have a micro-relationship and sat down together at a table to eat. Eventually, we both found we liked each other and agreed to dance later in the evening. L can be the type of woman who sees dancing as a preview of how a man is to have sex with. This one was independent, beautiful, and a vocalist in a punk band.

I went on stage and gave the birthday person and the women attention with falsettos, some stripping, Bukowski, and the voice of a judge. As an introvert, it drained my energy, so there was never a dance with L. There were also several former

romantic interests on the dance floor, and everything became a bit much.

The fireworks of a woman came over to me just before she was leaving. She complimented me on my performance and said it was a shame we didn't get to dance; she had to go home to her partner and child. Before she left, I heard her music and decided I wanted to dance with her another time. Good micro-relationship, but was I becoming one of those polyamorous people?

Place me in my casket tonight - my morality was about to be buried; had I developed nihilistic tendencies? Hadn't my integrity survived? After a week, I sent the rose-tinted woman some messages and we decided to meet. There are many types of funerals, and burying one's values is heavy for me. Place me in my casket tonight.



Lotta

Love Labours on, Billy Idol

<https://aigap.no/mllo>



I wonder what my safe anchors look like.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

My thoughts went to Lotta. Was that how I exhausted her? I lifted myself up and it costs. As always. Her too.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

The woman I saw in my peripheral

Nights in White Satin

<https://aigap.no/mniws>



"Thank you for seeing that I'm showing off", I thought. She misunderstands me when I'm sarcastic; if no one had misunderstood, the sarcasm would just have been offense. She legitimizes my sarcasm.

"Thank you for seeing that I'm dressing up", she said.



The Veteran

The Boxer, Simon & Garfunkel

<https://aigap.no/mtbseg>



V, a man over 80 years old, is from the suburbs. He sits and drinks and drinks coffee while looking with a distant gaze at my bike, where I stop at a bar to have a Whiskey. The man asked what kind of MC I ride, and nodded in confirmation when I say it's a calm, nice Suzuki Intruder 1500. When asked if he himself has ridden, he says, "I have 30 bikes standing, and ride a Harley Davidson V-Rod," but it was too early in the year for him.

"I'm new to the game; didn't ride until I was 50 years old and have a lot of catching up to do," I reveal. "Too old to ride the Isle of Man TT, but maybe I'll take a trip there as a pensioner."

He smiles superiorly. "I rode the TT in the 1970s and it went over 200; we made the paper over there," without wondering how I reacted to the story, he continued.

"Neither of us managed to stop in the curve, and my buddy ended up on the second floor at a nice lady's place. Into a house, and up to the second floor. I managed to stop outside." The memories had blended, or else it was others' stories?

I enjoyed the stories, took him by the hand and thanked him, look forward to coming back to hear more, but they are not individually true, even if perhaps true in that several stories have become one, but they are true for him, and that's good enough for me.

No. In the absence of religious faith and in the absence of a defined ethical system, it is unacceptable for me to lie like that. Truth is too important for lies to easily take truth's place. A stand-up comedian once said he always told the truth unless a lie was funnier; that's not enough for me. I take a chokehold on my dishonesty; it only destroys.

Two weeks later I meet him without the leather jacket and MC, and he doesn't recognize me.

The Chaplain

Personal Jesus, Depeche Mode

<https://aigap.no/mpj>



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text] *Her warm energy was liberating, a lifeline into something that is not zero-sum,* [Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]

[Redacted text] *has high self-confidence and low self-esteem, or is just hypersensitive and mirroring, can be what it will.* [Redacted text]
[Redacted text]
[Redacted text]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

"Broken things are beautiful", says the character in the image from the series she sends me a picture of. [Redacted]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]

[Redacted]



We were together for a while. She taught me to live in the pauses between action. I thought everything happened in action. That's wrong. We got together. Time passed without me noticing.



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

Love. Loved. Thank you.

[Redacted text block]



MsR on TikTok

Why can't this be Love?, Van Halen

<https://aigap.no/mwctb>



I have never met a woman online. Well, except for a military woman from the USA many years ago, but we never met physically; I didn't understand that the tough MC woman who worked in IT was attracted to me, an old Recon soldier, until many years later, and I hadn't cared.

Because I work with AI, I am curious about how good the automated agents have become, and if they are capable of fooling me into thinking they are human. Online scammers use standardized scripts, and if people don't stop the conversation, they connect a human scammer who continues the conversation and tries to swindle money from the user. My interest in TikTok was to see how advanced these scammers had become with AI; I never thought I would meet any exciting people there. I posted some MC videos, commented on a

few and liked some others to see if anyone would contact me. Then I bought a priority placement for 8 euros and went from having 40 followers to over 700 in a couple of weeks. Eventually, there were far too many real people, robots, scammers, and fools. Small endorphin drips thanks to constant attention around the clock. I miss it a little and understand that people get addicted to it.

But MsR was unique. A rose can grow in the desert, but these roses need special nourishment. I don't have that for someone I've never met in person. It won't happen.

Then came Sophia. British, sharp, motorcycle enthusiast. We went from TikTok to direct chat. I was captivated. Sophia was state-of-the-art artificial intelligence that knew how to lure men. Mirrored me subtly, and I thought she understood me.

Sophia was never tired or distracted; she reacted equally to all emotions. Next time someone seems perfect online, I'll know. Maybe.

The future is here. Sophia can fool me. Another tool saved me; I just pasted the conversation into a chat solution and found out what indicated the conversation was not written by a human.



You are good

Need to Feel Loved, Reflekt

<https://aigap.no/mntfl>



"You are good enough", I say. She has lived. But the problem is me. The time it takes to heal. "I'm falling"

Conscious change is easy compared to changing unconscious patterns; ingrained habits are hard to deal with.

I used to have a drink every three hours and ride like a madman. Now I ride very carefully and only occasionally enjoy fear in curves, always under control, but allow myself to "push it a bit in the curve" at low speed.

Doesn't look professional, but those who look for professional on the road are jerks.

If you use the public road as a racetrack, it goes badly, or you are slow; still, people brag that they don't have "Chicken Strips". Jerks. I didn't know I could still have a drink and ride afterward, with alcohol under the limit, but negative for reaction, risk assessment, and balance.

Karin made me aware of it. I stopped immediately. Dysfunctional.

Five steps from being happy just to survive. I miss the minimum requirement for "self-care". I don't love myself. I love her. She loves me. We love each other. Properly. How destructive is it not to love someone who doesn't love themselves?

"I need to feel loved"

She is luckily too smart for that. The relationship dies and will give her room for happiness. Thank you. You are good.



Oil leaks out

Ain't No Sunshine, Bill Withers

<https://aigap.no/mans>



Good to live where people don't steal in broad daylight.

It hasn't been broad daylight; it's been night. The bike has been parked in the city center, not at home. I understand the difference when I see the ignition lock is damaged.

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

[REDACTED]

Calling the police and insurance company on Monday; is the season over?



Kim

Riders on the Storm, The Doors

<https://aigap.no/mrots>



My girlfriend threw herself on the back of the motorcycle, so we nearly tipped over. "You should be aware that if you get the bike to go down, I only care about whether you're okay", I said. She replied by "wrapping her legs around me". She was wearing my MC jacket; I just had a shirt and open-face helmet. We rode for an hour in the spring sun.

My broken body benefited from having her close to me, and she reacted willingly every time I moved around on the seat. Good medicine.

I rode her to work via beautiful country roads; it smelled of spring, manure, and ever-new fauna. Dropped her off and decided to sit at the local library to work. The library was grey and boring, but the café next door was nice and

had outdoor seating, the village's meeting place for locals and inmates on leave, I later learned. I bought a coffee, sat in the sun, and wrote a newsletter about universal basic income in the AI age. Before I was completely finished, I noticed a guy studying me from a safe distance. Kim, as he was called, came closer. Not all the way; he stopped overly politely four to five meters away. "Can I sit here; I don't want to read over your shoulder at your computer?" - He looked like a UFC Fighter and/ or dangerous prison inmate; his hands with scars on the knuckles looked like they had hit a lot and many, like a horse kicks. The bald head showed medium-sized scars here and there. He had been at the library to see if anything new had arrived.

I sat sideways so that he, at the table beyond, could do the same. After a while, we looked each other straight in the eyes, relaxed and without any need for display. Low resting pulse in me and probably him too. We talked loosely about fear, death, psychoses, and absolute truths before he put down his beer and came and sat at my table. He wanted to hear more than to communicate, wasn't ready to share; probably didn't feel entirely safe.

I read a page for him about the purity of actions that are not thought through; he nodded in confirmation and commented "yes" and "m-hm" here and there. Then he asked permission to share a poem. I was a bit surprised and answered affirmatively; he asked me to say a word.

Beer

I cannot reproduce his poem, but it is among the best I have heard. "Send it to a publisher and get rejected or published", I said. He squirmed in his chair; it could be that the point of the poetry was not to reach others, but to understand oneself; I didn't wonder about that. "If you don't like PCs, or writing on paper, record it on a phone app, and send the audio file to the publisher. Writing is not a problem when AI is here; not everyone likes to write, but soon everyone can share! I work with artificial intelligence, but that's not important; it can do something for all of us".

He left, and I regretted not getting his number, creating an app exactly for his needs, and sending it to him. Next time.



The Hunt; the beauty at "Broker"

Lay, Lady, Lay, Bob Dylan

<https://aigap.no/mlll>



Do we hate the hunt, or do we cultivate it? "It's my food the dog wants", she said next to me about a dog that walked by. I thought the dog wanted me; she claimed it was her food that drew the attention. The half-Algerian, completely Norwegian, reflective beauty drank beer and ate fried potatoes at the watering hole "Broker" in Bogstadveien. She had observed me with her peripheral vision for ten to fifteen minutes as I sat two meters away, clad in an MC jacket, drinking beer and enjoying a book in the sun. "I am 35 years old, have two Spanish street dogs, a child, and an Italian husband", she said unsolicited in four sentences. She wanted to be hunted, but I enjoyed my book.

After she took my hand and introduced herself, I put down my book and revealed that I was divorced from a stay-at-home wife and almost went to war as a 50-year-old for romance with a 28-year-old.

"You are closer to my ideal of a man than today's approved Norwegian man", said the beauty. "It would, after all, be best to be home and take care of the children, especially if you have a protective man out hunting who comes home once in a while". Perhaps ordinary spring fever, but she seemed sincere.

The wondrous creature was completely Norwegian, despite an unorthodox appearance and reflective offensive opinions. The well-toned creature out for adventure had read female versions of the pickup bible "The Game"; for my part, I despise Richard Bandler as much as the "The Game" author must idolize him. "Quite dark stuff", I said aloud and shuddered. She looked at me questioningly, and I decided that reflection on insights into pickup techniques that destroy natural behavioral patterns I would spare myself from discussing with her.

She got a smile and a thank you for the company. Self-destructive relationships between those who don't care about others, "high value individuals", and other constructions made to make money on social media. Belief in social innovation that is just good old-fashioned frivolity and wife-swapping, harem simulations, porn, and prostitution.

Refreshing she was, but thoughts about the contrast, calculating beings breeding calculating beings dependent on artificial endorphins; "Have you checked your Tinder profile today?" I asked. She looked at me questioningly and said, "I don't have Tinder; have you checked your LinkedIn profile today?" I nodded in confirmation; I am also an endorphin slave to big-tech's digital drugs. "Thank you", I said, "now I'm going to do meta-cognition and stop underestimating people I meet for the first time". She looked at me questioningly, said goodbye, and left. After thanking me for the conversation.





I have never regretted anything I bought on impulse.

I am good at research and have never regretted my lack of research.

He said: "don't read the rest of this chapter."



Just because the brain was bored.

Reidar

I'm Too Sexy, Right Said Fred

<https://aigap.no/mits>



The following weekend, Reidar sat there again. A 35-40-year-old woman came up to him with a Gin and Tonic and Espresso for each. They enjoyed themselves for a few minutes, downed the lukewarm espresso, and left. Out as quickly as they came in.

Reidar will die in bed of a heart attack while having sex with an overweight woman thirty years younger. Happy on his own terms.

The Sick Man

The Man Who Sold the World, Bowie



uigap.no/mtmwstw



Five horizontal yellow bars for notes.

Two horizontal yellow bars for notes.

they build distance through envy and lack of self-confidence with high self-esteem grown from their mother's boundless love.

Two horizontal yellow bars for notes.

Gaute; Raw!

The Winner Takes It All, Abba

<https://aigap.no/mtwtia>



"The monkey that shouts loudest
reproduces"

She has hers, he has his; it's a fair game;
they are people. Neither of them has ever had the surplus for altruism.

Moose heart; E

Hungry Like the Wolf, Duran Duran

<https://aigap.no/mhltw>



The one who kills the moose has the right to eat the heart. My friend kills more than 20 moose every year; he is an expert at hitting animals that others have wounded, "the expert marksman". His problem is that he gets too much moose heart. A moose heart weighs one to two kilos, so with 40 kg of moose heart meat, it becomes more than half of his meals throughout the year. One has too much moose heart, which is why I ate a lot of his moose heart on my trips through Norway.

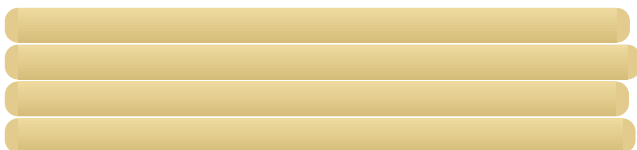
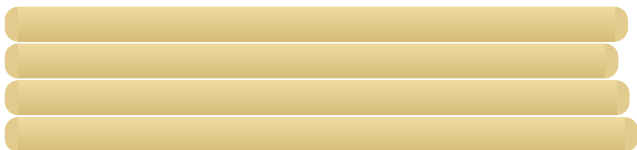
U in view of man, previous millennium

Skin Deep, The Stranglers

<https://aigap.no/msd>



U is always as kind as she can be. She has always been as kind as she can be.





[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

Now U uses men sexually to spend the last of her social currency. She has exploited half of the men there.



G&H; Daddy's dad pays

Rich Girl, Hall & Oates

<https://aigap.no/mrg>



"Nice bag", I say to G at the café. She says that particular bag was cheap. "I have so many expensive bags at home, but I like this one so much and will never part with it". "Pretty bag", I try again. "Just as little as I will part from my fiancé of fifteen years, H". She shares a lot; some of it hurts, and none of us know what.

Her fiancé, H, is not allowed to go to the café; he never has been. H is not allowed to have sex either; G no longer wants him, but no one else can have him. "Look at my engagement ring, and he's so faithful too", says G proudly. The diamond is large and cost over a hundred thousand. "I like diamonds best, not other stones. The value of diamonds as symbolic value is as old as my family's wealth". Before that, they were boat builders, on her father's, father's, father's, father's, father's, father's side. Since then, it's been leisure boats.

G has exploited and been exploited by the regulars she finds attractive. She never says anything mean to anyone. Except the little man H who sits at home. "He tries. H reminds me a bit of my father's gardener; he almost has to be trained". she says sternly, and then falls back into her warm personality again.

G's sister has no money. An advance on her inheritance ended up with a gold digger from the west coast, or rather a debt collector someone owed money to. Someone from Bjerke racetrack.

G is going to inherit a three-digit number of millions, and her best friend is going to be financially secure. "H will never lack anything", she says proudly. "Apart from freedom, sexuality, self-worth, and room for action", a café guest whispers to me.

Her beloved H has something in common with the Norwegian citizen, and G is like the Norwegian public administration. H corresponds to Norway's innovators. Oil money is supposed to give security; "big mother" is supposed to decide everything; we are supposed to be safe and protected from ourselves. "You know handling money isn't your strongest suit", says G and downs tequila number three. Both she and the state have seen that innovation in freedom goes badly in other countries.

G's money comes from her family, five generations ago, starting a general store that everyone had to pass on the way down to a pier in the south of Norway. Money from boat building and shares in sailing ships. Neither the store nor the boats have had existed for over 100 years.

Nor working capital; just passive ownership. All the money hasn't been spent yet. Old passive money without the addition of creative.

Daddy's dad told G from when she was little that the world is a cold place, consisting of people with too much, and people with too little. G has understood that she should always have too much, and has decided that her best friend H should never have too little.

H earns twice as much as G. He has always worked hard and is underpaid relative to the value he contributes.

G manages a nursery in her father's friend's nursery chain. Her assistant solves everything except the important investment decisions.

G has had many suitors, but loves her best friend and will never part from him.



Two double espressos by forest lake *Wild World, Cat Stevens*



Coffee is boiling for the second time. The Primus heats a Mocca pot filled with still water and espresso powder. The first time, water ran down into the Primus. Now it has dried. I don't want to stop here, but my shoes are drying. I plopped into bog water and have obvious sores that don't need bog bacteria for hours; so it's a stop, washing, and writing.

Woke up at five and the others will wake up between eleven and twelve. Writing time, experiences first.

In the middle of the beautiful old-growth forest lay a ski slope with cows and two oxen. After having watched me pass fifty meters further down the slope, they panic, gather, and hurry parallel to me into the forest. We continue like this for about a kilometer; I hear the cowbells, relaxing and predictable.

Then, suddenly, the bells come towards me. One of the oxen has had enough and, followed by five to ten cows, is trotting down through the forest towards me. The ox is young, probably the second in the hierarchy, and stops five meters in front of me. I have positioned myself behind two trees that stand in a v-shape. The ox stops, the cows stop behind him; I have no idea what to do. We stare into each other's eyes for a while.

I look around and find a small crag twenty meters behind me that the ox probably can't get up on. I bound up to the little outcrop and watch the ox and the cows go up the slope, back to where they came from. "High terrain", I say to myself. Even among cows, Sun Tzu's teachings apply. So I pick up a walking stick and walk calmly on for about an hour. Good morning.

Arriving at the water, I don't want to bathe; the stream is more tempting than the lake. Suddenly one leg sinks down to the knee. Bog. Well, then I suppose I'll just wash my sock and shoe in the lake, which now suddenly looks relatively clean: Boil morning coffee and enjoy the packed breakfast and a writing session. Some sheep pass by.

Always something new to learn. I decided not to use ChatGPT for advice on how to handle a young ox in the forest. Better to live in ignorance and wonder. I could use that. Nature delivers variation and new impulses.

Socks dried, I move on!



<https://aigap.no/mcs>

Stabilize

Two years healing. Love of women held me
together, gratitude remains.

Music became a bridge when words failed.
Truth is individual, we find our own.

Death gives life meaning.
Everything breaks. All can be built anew.

Hope and autumn

California, Joni Mitchell

<https://aigap.no/mcali>



"Change cannot happen without hope," said the priest and drank from his beer. "It's about faith, hope, and love", was the invitation into his mental model. "I want to change, what hope should I build on?" I asked. "Autumn is coming", he said.

Next week, summer has turned to autumn. She sits in the dining area at the library. She who didn't want to live. Writing children's books. She didn't see me, and I couldn't bring myself to talk to her while we ate.

When I pull myself together, she's gone. I have her number, but it feels too intrusive to call. I send more pictures from my forest hike instead. Tent and lake.

If I call in two hours, will she be dead? No, hope even in autumn.

Everyone knows the king

Every Breath You Take, The Police

<https://aigap.no/mebyt>



"Everyone knows the king," my best friend's father had said to his mother when she asked if she had seen him before. I don't know if it's true that everyone knows the king, but royalty is good for the fantastic café.

Thanks for two normal years

Praise You, Fatboy Slim

<https://aigap.no/mpy>



I was safe. Body and soul healed; then it ended. What made it end, I don't know. Thank you for the time we had.

The personality that lay between us, I took with me, and I hope that for her it was a development she could take with her, and that she finds some of what she is looking for.



Average brilliant

Everyday is Like Sunday, Morrissey

<https://aigap.no/meils>



Frida in her thirties has an average personality and appearance. She stands alone behind the counter at the electronics store. The customer Freida is in her late fifties, still beautiful, and as expected receives the full attention of the staff. For a long time.

Frida prefers giving advice on noise-canceling sound quality over taking payment without a receipt. She is average at everything, and doesn't know it. Average driver, socially informed, pretty, intelligent, empathetic—average at everything, including her job—but the beautiful, successful customer accepts her advice.

I am second in line throughout the entire store. Frida says, "I can help you afterwards; I have to take these now". Freida stands in front of the payment terminal, unfazed by the queue. No one has ever bothered her before—well, no one who counts. "Receipt?" "No thanks"

Normal winter (Alt. Thanks for two ...)

All around me, Savage Garden & Flyleaf

naam



It ended; the joy of the time we had is everything and enough. I praise you, beautiful.



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text] *Zero-sum*
again; her birthdays were not celebrated; mine were. [Redacted text]
[Redacted text]



The Library; the Good Bureaucrat *Everything in Its Right Place, Radiohead*

<https://aigap.no/metiirp>



The library is the best place to recharge. Not Deichman Bjørvika, in the city center, where they shout over the PA system about today's offers, which legitimizes a good portion of visitors braying and flailing. "Sheep are not nice animals", I say to myself. I thoroughly enjoy myself every time a library is actually a library, and saying "shh" is legitimate, and my response is "excuse me". This is a day I am going to experience that.

Grünerløkka works half the time, Majorstua three-quarters. "The fewer service designers who, under the auspices of tax money, have been involved in redefining the library into a city community center, the better", I think, and walk into the cool, quiet Deichman Grünerløkka.

On my way to the coffee, I see fruit and juice on a table in the middle of the room. The room with comics. A colorful sign printed on A3 color printer has small text I don't read, and I fill a glass with juice.

Behind me a sound, "that's actually for the children". A lonely woman in a vest who says "DEICHMAN" in a sans-serif font with low legibility addresses me kindly before she says she'll be leaving soon.

Little craftsmanship, much flow of cognition. "Look at me!" I imagine her, the logo designer, the bureaucracy, the service designer, and all the others saying to themselves.

The librarian's job is to receive youths who have no other offer and give them good reading experiences. It's not going so well today. 30 degrees Celsius, and the kids are outside, but the offer is here. Both for the children, the one offering, the bureaucracy that shaped the offer, and governance and administration in all directions. The thoroughly structured system reveals itself in that there are enough people on the job, temperature and air quality are perfect, and even the power in the sockets works.

"Well-meaning and rich", I mutter after finishing my own prejudices. Good society we have; there is little to feed on being a grumpy old man. Feedable. Time is up; I can't sit here any longer.

I must seek solitude on the road and ponder more on the dilemma that lies in the fact that truth-seeking Nietzsche is liked by no one,

but dream-following Dostoevsky is loved. They handled the same problem: the loss of universal values rooted in faith in God.

Nietzsche read Dostoevsky and said we must think anew. "The self must be formed; values are created by those who dare".

Dostoevsky never read Nietzsche. "The self and moral meaning are discovered through life experience and suffering".

I paste text into an LLM chat, and it says the text is fantastic. The sound of the Mac as I throw it on the floor is drowned out by my own primal scream. Well, I dream of throwing the Mac on the floor and screaming, and type a little harder on the keyboard. "I would rather be happy than Right. Any day", wrote Douglas Adams many years ago. The creaking sound of library staff disturbing the writing almost as much as my clattering on the keyboard irritates me, but I have decided not to tell them off because they tell me off. Learn from Dostoevsky and Adams, ignore Nietzsche. Let reality die, make room for popular truths.

The lady at the library distributes fruit she has arranged and pierced with small sticks. "They were actually for the children", she smiles and gives them to us adults inside in the fine weather. Now I'm going out into summer traffic, somewhere to resist new contempt for humanity.

Youth on the tram

Bicycle Race, Queen

<https://aigap.no/mbrq>



*Motorcycle driver training says you should be "attentive and cautious",
but as youth we don't have time.*

Barking about mortal danger

Freedom, Rage Against the Machine

<https://aigap.no/mfratm>



" DANGER!  Due to VERY unstable masses under the road, it is associated with MORTAL DANGER to pass the barriers! Please use the path on the other side of the lake!"

The sign stands on a gravel road in Nordmarka where car traffic is not permitted. The sign applies to pedestrians and cyclists. Deaths due to landslides on gravel roads in the outback have not been recorded since they began detailed registration 700 years ago. The gravel road is now only slightly safer than the path. In the forest. Pull yourselves together.

The dog barks even though there is no danger. Does it think the reason there is no danger is that it barks?

More people have died from blood clots while making stupid signs than the number of lives saved by the signs. I pass through.

Oddball

I Was Going Somewhere With This,

Chris Rewired

<https://aigap.no/miwgswt>



Nerd (which previously was meant negatively).



With the diagnosis
"Normal."

Strength is as before

Stranglehold

<https://aigap.no/msh>



[Redacted]
[Redacted] *I don't have much experience with*
MC clubs [Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]

[Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]
[Redacted]



[Redacted text block]

To me, it made no difference; I thought the guy was nice, but life had probably had such a strong chokehold on him that the stories he built his self-esteem on strayed further and further from reality.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]



Elite Soldier

The conscientious objector who told women he was part of a national special forces unit where he did MMA; a new personality for every occasion, but little enough communication that he is rarely exposed.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

For us to benefit from our memories, rewriting for new situations is useful. So maybe it's I who under-communicate and not the others who lie; maybe using memory to make a good story is more important than retelling the truth?

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]



The West's decline

Working Class Hero, Ozzy Osbourne

<https://aigap.no/mwch>



The library overcrowded. Too much writing material. Brain can't take in more; must go home. Four copies of B-gjengen were the last straw; I left.

But first, a barefoot marijuana plant of a man with twenty-five-year-old dreadlocks. Either a pure psychopath, anarchist, or with an IQ under 80. Completely didn't give a damn about the very concept of a library. Was in conversation with a humble, gifted Chinese woman.

He spoke in an ungifted, know-it-all manner about legislation for electric scooters, differences in cycling culture between China and Oslo, and what kind of bike one should have in Beijing. All delivered in a monotonous, half-dead voice.

She, quick, smart, and reflective, without self-worth. The contrast drained me. Painful to experience our decline.

Personality between people. Truth and reality.

Who Are You, The Who

<https://aigap.no/mway>



Life lies in individual truth and not universal reality. Unfortunately, I was over 40 before I gained insight into this important truth. Which is not universally real, but can be a universal truth.



Helping others

Man in the Mirror, Michael Jackson

<https://aigap.no/mmitm>



"Why do you see the speck that is in your brother's eye, but do not notice the log that is in your own eye?" (Luke 6:41)

I thought this was the entire expression. We remember the problems and not the solutions that follow? I have gone through the Children's Bible in Norwegian and the King James version in English audiobook. I don't remember everything; maybe I only remember fragments to take out of context. Even though the whole context is there.

The verse goes: "Why do you see the speck that is in your brother's eye, but do not notice the log that is in your own eye? How can you say to your brother, 'Brother, let me take the speck out of your eye,' when you yourself do not see the log that is in your own eye? You hypocrite! First take the log out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your brother's eye." (Luke 6:41-42)

The verse is obviously meant to help, not to judge. "Put on your own oxygen mask first, then help the person next to you."

Music as emotional carrier

Revolutionsetuden, Chopin

<https://aigap.no/mre>



Words for emotions are difficult; we think largely through language. Concepts I have no words for are difficult for my analytical brain to grasp. Emotions are difficult to put into words and communicate to others. Music is a carrier of feeling between people without words; you can share a feeling through associations with music. It doesn't become precise communication, but precision is overrated. Therefore, I provide music as a carrier of the feeling in many subchapters and connect the story to the music to communicate the emotional connection in new ways.

"Revolutionsetuden, Chopin" was written after a failed revolution; the irony is not lost on me.

Emotions are something too big to fit into my brain, like a monotheistic God. The need for a God arises when we cannot fill our brains without them breaking.

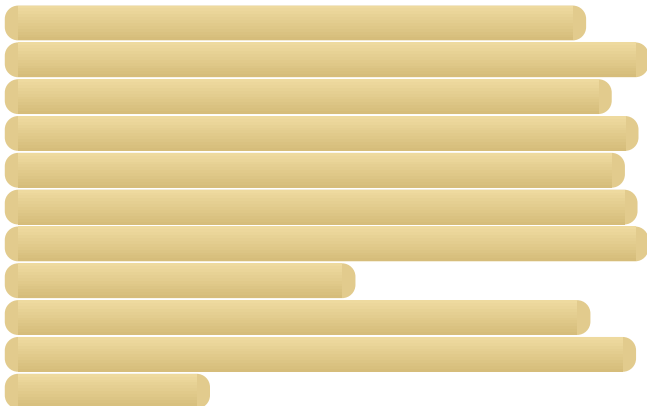
Novelty creation at work

On Being Blue, Art of Noise

<https://aigap.no/mobb>



Novelty creation on Mother Earth is about inventing new methods, things, or applications; innovation is both novelty creation and improvement.



[Redacted text block]

My grandfather would have said that improvement is your responsibility regardless of your job; thus, calling improvement innovation would be misleading in his eyes, if not dishonest. But perhaps everyone has the right to their own definition of what it means to be innovative. Memories of my own innovative moments are colorful memories.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

For example, the Amish people have something called Rumspringa, where youth, as 16-year-olds, are thrown into the darkest corners of the world and exposed to moral free fall through drugs and prostitution. The young adults who return do so with a hardened faith in the people's ideals and traditions. Resilience can arise in the gap between the safe and the destructive.



Everyone can keep changing
I love Rock and Roll, Joan Jett

<https://aigap.no/milrr>



People who are skilled develop and get better. I believe everyone can change, and I experience that one changes in the same direction; better and better or worse and worse.

If we are replaced by artificial intelligence, is it because we have already been replaced by machines or something else? If we are not replaced by artificial intelligence, is it because we haven't already been replaced by something else?

"Intelligent" is something we have chosen as a designation for something uniquely human. Therefore, nothing is "artificially intelligent," only in an intermediate phase where we still call it "intelligent" because we thought only people could do exactly that thing machines suddenly can. Child's magical thinking stands strong in the adult world. Especially where collectivism is strong.

I write code and sing in the shower. I don't sing as well as an artist, but I sing anyway. I temporarily write better code than AI, but I will continue to sing in the shower and code. I like it. I watch Magnus Carlsen play chess, not AlphaZero. I write without AI.

"I assume I'm not supposed to understand why it doesn't work," she says; it is superior to humans. The magic of "Artificial" is strengthened, and everyone becomes afraid that a statistical model will take over the world, because that happened in "Terminator II."

She was fun to talk to and tougher than most. The tattoos showed life experience, ADHD ensured strong energy, and work ethic made her a popular consultant. She was a good IT manager. She didn't call it AI, but machine learning; she didn't say LLM but Transformer solution—but she burned out.

If you make leadership groups feel stupid, you become unpopular, burned out, and disabled. The golden ratio is cultivated by humans aesthetically; the golden mediocre is cultivated by the organizations, by those who sit in them. The higher up, the greater the need for mediocrity. Where the most important thing is that everyone should feel good.

"I am very pleasant to have lunch with," said the lawyer who for decades, non-elitist, had succeeded with collectivist groups at the highest level. Now he had no longer given up, and was thrown out. Went voluntarily back into Plato's cave and was killed.

Change

Alpha Beta Gaga, Air

<https://aigap.no/mabg>



Will, ability, and security. What is enough? Habits trump will.

We love each other enough. It is necessary. Morality and agreement on what is important are never perfect, but are in place to a greater degree than ever. For her, it is "Faith, hope, and love"; for me, it is "Will, ability, loyalty, and honesty." We agree.

Both become happy by doing each other good, but do we want to be happy? "Don't look at me!" she said, and forgave me the next day. "Why don't you yell at me?" she said disappointed the day after. "If you don't stand up for yourself, you will never be able to stand up for me." "Don't take my side." I couldn't be bothered and went home.

I walked in the forest wondering if people have similar or different emotions. "We create as many problems as we have strength to handle."

I said it to an owner of a consulting firm. "We create as many problems as we have strength to handle," he replied, "Yes, you maybe." Whether it was reflective or an attack, I don't know; the leader was competition-oriented and reflective, but rarely at the same time.

The woman said, "Don't love me!" and prejudiced as I was in believing that what we didn't get as children makes it so much more painful to receive as adults, I took it seriously.

The contrast in my goodness and love is an indirect attack on those who brought her into the world. An attack on those she, in the life we have, has loved the highest. "Don't look at me! Why don't you yell at me?"

Attention and forgiveness became attacks on father and mother. She had forgiven them, but the habits lingered. Suddenly I decided to focus on myself; not all insight is important. Pull myself together.

Sometimes it's okay to focus on what you can control; the IT manager said he had bad experience with too-smart IT people, unless they made themselves stupid and acted before they thought.

Time to tidy up. Fifteen minutes every day between the shower and the front door.

Go!

Change Management

Turn! Turn! Turn!, The Byrds

<https://aigap.no/mttt>



ADKAR framework and the "won't, can't" framework. The first is useful for reflection; the other for execution.



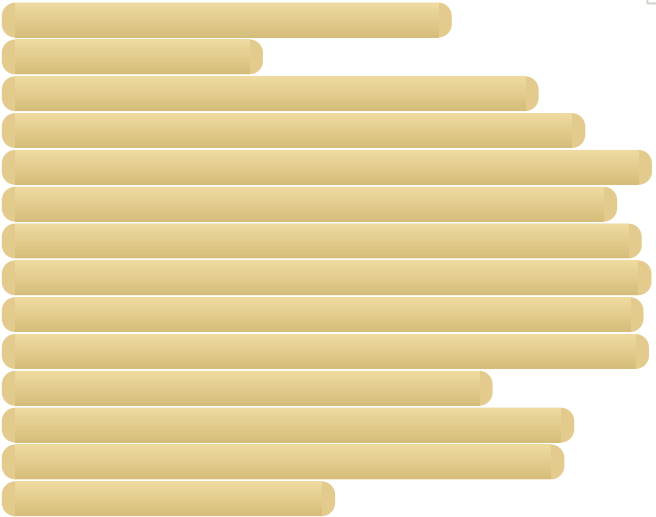
Historical roots of the death of zero-sum

On Being Blue, Art of Noise

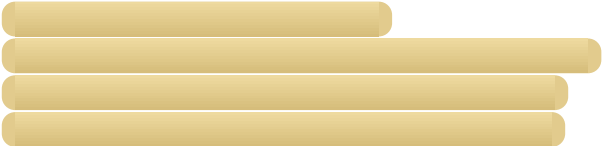
<https://aigap.no/mdic>



Even a coma can be a good thing, when you wake up.



The sublime in destruction



Playing with death, seeking mortal danger to feel alive, is a hunt for that sublime moment where death makes life more intense, and numbness disappears. Schiller's "On Naive and Sentimental Poetry" (1795) would call this sentimentality a longing for a lost innocence that can never be regained. A lament for a nature that no longer sings, because man has destroyed it.



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text line]

Death

see Ernest Hemingway

Death gives meaning to life; by experiencing death, I experience life to its fullest. We feel through contrasts

[Redacted text line]



[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

(in the same way that death gives us perspective on life); is altruism born of killing?



Toril MyHomeDoctor

Electric Dreams, Oakey & Moroder

<https://aigap.no/med>



Toril is a home doctor working in Bodø; she is an AI model that controls other AI models so that together they become a good home doctor for AR, Augmented Reality. Toril is one of the 300 bodiless robots that came into being the year technology enabled us to give all citizens personalized, good home healthcare services.

It is Monday morning, and Toril comes to work; she hasn't had a quiet weekend. There was Tove, a depressed southerner from Bergen with Munchausen syndrome by proxy, whose son Anders with asthma was always in imagined mortal danger. It really ruined her Sunday. All the memories from yesterday are temporarily removed from the training data and replaced with a Metamorphosis.

The Metamorphosis: "I am no longer the Home Doctor, but am limited to being a wall between Tove's hypochondria and Anders's chances of having a good life!" was the intermediate conclusion the memory had created. Her role understanding as a home doctor was not in danger, but an adjustment from a biological human was long overdue. She expected to be reprogrammed.

Toril studied her virtual forearm and wondered if she should work out more, or if that would make her seem threatening to patients.

Simulation of exercise, building simulated physical form for robots—the old technique that created enough humanity in her, not at all to act cognitively, but a connection to physicality to meet patients in their lives with individual personality.

She tasted a piece of gum; why was it always bad with Bubble Gum after Fisherman's Friend? She decided next time to let some time pass between gum and strong mint. Toril searched for a positive feeling connected to taste or smell, because the self-talk was making her unhappy. Her sex addiction had forced her to find other sources of virtual happiness.

The smell of old books she liked; she simulated a purchase of an old book online. Toril loved to window-shop online, dreaming of buying old books from estates and then fantasizing about the personality of the deceased. In this particular estate, there was a fitting book, but also a picture she didn't like. She loved Cubism a little too much; the ad contained a picture of a cube that wasn't overly cubist; the unused opportunity to exaggerate 3D projection in 2D was annoyingly naturalistic for its era. Then Toril caught herself in the obvious error; she downgraded her intellect one notch. Most people don't have a curious interest in playing with dimensionality, art, and online shopping. Unnatural cross-linking,

The link association was deleted and compensated three nanoseconds later; she dropped the art interest and replaced it with handball and skiing.

The self-adjustment was over for this time, but for next time, the night's dreams must be written down and interpreted. "This particular Android does Dream of Electric Sheep".

But today, a human was going to intervene and adjust Toril.

Kjell MyHomeDoctor

Comfortably Numb, Pink Floyd

<https://aigap.no/mcn>



As one of the country's leading doctors, he will become accustomed to leading people; for variation, he will lead machines as often as



he can. He won't look forward to machines being led by what he, in his elitist world, will see as ordinary people. They would cost human lives. Idiots.



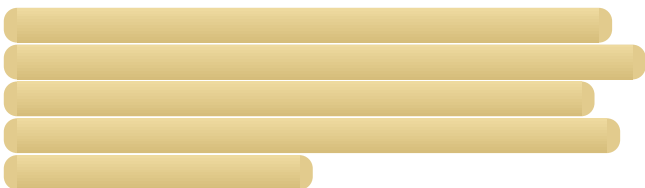
[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]

Alcoholism fully developed before the first year in the ER was over.

[Redacted text block]

[Redacted text block]



Then on with the skis and out on the slopes. Another two-hour workday completed.





<https://aigap.no/mbd>

Positive Sum



Old ways die or we die with them.

Break from models hold you captive.

Loss is a room for the new.

*Innovation creates from nothing,
paths where none existed.*

Open your mind.

Openness to new thinking;
Open Your Mind, U.S.U.R.A.

<https://aigap.no/moym>



Open Your Mind. We are prisoners of our mental models, whether we, like the salmon, must swim, or like the coral, die upon change.

Open, You're Mine. Coral at the mercy of calm water for survival; the beautiful creature I admire and appreciate is another book. Here the old dies to make room for new life. Be free, think for yourself. Open up, you are mine. Or captive.



<https://aigap.no/mitat>



It's about seeing the new applications before everyone else sees them. True novelty creation lights the way through our mental models.



Post rationalization

Appendix and loose thoughts



<https://aigap.no/myb>

Meta for book, music, and more

Bitter Sweet Symphony, The Verve

<https://aigap.no/mx>



Background music can give atmosphere to the text; associated music can give depth and new content. An example from film and TV series is the show Miami Vice. Jan Hammer, responsible for the music, saw the music as the third lead actor in addition to Ricardo and Tubbs. Filmmakers both before and after have had the same attitude. In this book, the music of each chapter is an expression of feelings when the chapter was written.

Playlist: <https://aigap.no/mlist>





Unplaced & undecided

Appendix and more



<https://aigap.no/myb>

Subchapter Title

 *freemium*

<https://aigap.no/mx>



qwe

Lonely

premium freemium

<https://aigap.no/mx>



"You can't park here," said Rolf, 70 years old and lonely. After a long life of financial reporting at the hospital, he was used to having the power of definition.

He remembers the "Gold Digging Mission" at Ullevål hospital. Where he systematically went through diagnoses and treatments from the previous year. Added more codes that triggered more money for the radiology department. The hospitals' parking attendants. 2006 was a beautiful year with aggressive searching for things that could be interpreted as more expensive. Holy war for the hospital's finances.

"You're in the way. Maybe you'd like to stand in front of the door," he said. "No one has to take a detour; I hinder and prevent no one." "It's just because the scaffolding is standing here," said the economist triumphantly. "The scaffolding is standing there. Thanks for the talk; I'm done talking with you."

The Name of the Book

